

Light shy

Astronomers prefer to be away from artificial lights and as high up as they can get. If you live in a town, see if it's possible to plan a visit to a darker area where you can observe the night sky.

The Milky Way is best observed away from towns and cities and the artificial light they create.

I see a planet!

Look for Venus just after sunset in the western sky or just before sunrise in the eastern sky.

Venus is also called the "morning star" and the "evening star". It is always close to the Sun.



Our galaxy, the Milky Way, appears as a burst of stars in a thick band across the night sky.

Try meteor spotting

The best time to look for meteors is when the Earth is passing through meteoroids and a meteor shower is expected. Watch the skies between mid-July and late August when the Earth passes through a swarm of meteors called the Perseids. Or try the Orionids between the middle and end of October.

